COMP 5212 Fall 2026

Course Logistics

1 Prerequisites and Materials

Students are expected to be familiar with **probability** and **linear algebra**, and to be proficient in **Python programming**. The CMU 10-701 Self-Assessment Exam is a useful resource for obtaining a rough sense of the background expected for this course.

This course does not use a required textbook. The following references may be helpful:

- Probability Review
- The Matrix Cookbook
- Linear Algebra Review

2 Honor Code

Students are encouraged to discuss homework problems in groups. However, each student must write the homework solutions and code **independently**. If you discuss a homework assignment with others, please list the names of the people with whom you discussed it.

You may not copy, refer to, or look at exact solutions from previous years, online sources, or other unauthorized resources. Cheating on examinations is strictly prohibited.

Use of generative AI tools. Generative AI tools such as ChatGPT and Claude may be used to assist with homework. However, you may not directly copy answers generated by these tools and submit them as your own work. You remain responsible for understanding and independently producing every submitted solution.

Honor code violations. We have **zero tolerance** for honor code violations. A single violation will result in failure of the course.

3 Grading

The final grade is determined as follows:

- **5 assignments: 40%**
- **Midterm exam: 25%**
- **Final exam: 35%**

Assignments. There will be five assignments: three written assignments and two hands-on assignments. The three written assignments together account for **20%** of the final grade, and the two hands-on assignments together account for the remaining **20%**.

Exams. For both the midterm exam and the final exam, you may bring up to **two A4-size, double-sided cheat sheets**.

4 Submitting Assignments

Assignment release, submission, and grading will be handled through **Canvas**, unless otherwise specified by the course staff.

Each student has a total of **three free late calendar days** to use across homework assignments. Once these late days are exhausted, late submissions will receive a **20% penalty per late day**.

No assignment will be accepted more than **three calendar days** after its due date. Each 24-hour period, or any fraction thereof, counts as one full late day.

5 Lecture Video Policy

Lecture videos will be available on Canvas, but they will normally be released only twice during the semester: once before the midterm exam and once before the final exam. In special circumstances, such as lectures scheduled around holidays, the corresponding videos may be released earlier.

To protect the rights and privacy of students and instructors in the classroom, you may **not share, repost, distribute, or upload lecture videos** outside the authorized course platforms.